

A breakthrough partnership with MI pioneer Dr. Kenneth Resnicow reshaped how Aetna communicates with members—shifting from scripted calls to meaningful, human-centered conversations.

The Challenge

Traditional disease-management programs across the industry were failing to truly engage members. Scripted, compliance-first coaching left people feeling unheard — and caused high dropout rates.

Aetna's Solution

Aetna partnered with Dr. Kenneth Resnicow, a global leader in Motivational Interviewing, to train its care teams in a new approach built on empathy, autonomy, and real dialogue.

"A highly personalized member experience with real conversations, not scripted interactions."

— Aetna Leadership

What Changed

MI rewired Aetna's coaching model with conversations that:

- Strengthen intrinsic motivation
- Increase readiness for change
- Build trust through collaboration rather than persuasion

Proven Outcomes

After integrating MI into Care Management & Disease Management programs, Aetna achieved:

- 43% increase in member engagement (53.1% – 76%)
- 55% decrease in dropouts
- Better adherence to care plans
- Improved productivity and fewer disability claims for plan sponsors



Dr. Kenneth Resnicow

One of the world's leading experts in Motivational Interviewing, whose work spans healthcare, behavior change, chronic illness, and health equity. His partnership with Aetna helped operationalize MI at scale and set a national precedent for member-centered coaching.

Why MI Works

Motivational Interviewing shifts the focus from telling people what to do – to helping them discover why they want to do it.

This creates:

- Higher participation
- More consistent behavior change
- Stronger long-term health outcomes